

EVIDENCE OF TEACHING ABILITY

Katie Apker

PhD Candidate - Cornell University

Organizational Behavior - ILR School

COURSES TAUGHT

Teaching assistant - Cornell ILR, undergraduate. Lectured for weekly discussion sections, built class plans and in-class materials, and contributed to the weekly instructor meeting for the course on pedagogy and assessment.

- *Sociology of Work* (Macro Organizational Behavior), ILRID 1530/1531 and 1535 - Spring 2024 and Spring 2026 (Drs. Eli Friedman, Ben Rissing, and Devin Wiggs)
- *Psychology of Work* (Micro Organizational Behavior), ILRID 1520/1521 - Fall 2023 (Drs. Vanessa Bohns and Brad Bell)

Teaching assistant - Cornell Johnson & BYU, graduate and MBA/EMBA. Supported instruction through grading, review sessions, and student support.

- *Managing and Leading in Organizations*, Executive MBA - 2021-2022, Cornell SC Johnson (Dr. Michelle Duguid)
- *Strategic Management of Technology & Innovation*, graduate summer course - 2021-2022, Cornell SC Johnson (Dr. Andrew Foley)
- *Creative Strategic Thinking*, MBA elective - 2019-2021, BYU Marriott (Dr. Jeff Dyer)
- *Corporate Finance*, MBA core - 2019-2021, BYU Marriott (Dr. Grant McQueen)

STUDENT EVALUATIONS

The table below reports student evaluations from the ILR organizational behavior undergraduate sections I led. Students evaluated each teaching assistant and section instructor separately, and the ratings below are those specific to me as an instructor. Ratings are for the summary item “Overall, the quality of my teaching is,” on a 1 (low) to 5 (high) scale.

Course	Term	Overall
Sociology of Work (Macro OB), ILRID 1530/1531	Spring 2024, 2026	4.69 / 5
Psychology of Work (Micro OB), ILRID 1520/1521	Fall 2023	4.72 / 5
Overall (6 sections)	2023–2026	4.71 / 5

STRONGEST EVALUATION DIMENSIONS

Across the fifteen evaluation items, students rated me most highly on the dimensions central to an effective discussion section:

- Makes students feel free to ask questions: 4.87 / 5
- Willing to help students outside of class: 4.84 / 5
- Organized in presenting the material: 4.82 / 5
- Conveys enthusiasm in teaching the material: 4.81 / 5

STUDENT COMMENTS

Engagement and enthusiasm

- “Was absolutely amazing. I learned the content because my TA was so engaging.” (*Sociology of Work, Spring 2024*)
- “Her enthusiasm and personality foster an environment where people feel willing and excited to engage in the discussion, and where students feel they are in a safe space to share.” (*Psychology of Work, Fall 2023*)
- “The best TA for psych. I looked forward to her discussion more than the class itself.” (*Psychology of Work, Fall 2023*)
- “She is also personable and kind. Katie is very positive and knows all the material.” (*Sociology of Work and Organizations, Spring 2026*)

Inclusive discussion facilitation

- “She made sure everyone’s voices were heard and clarified points that we didn’t understand fully.” (*Psychology of Work, Fall 2023*)
- “She calls on a diverse group of students instead of prioritizing some, and creates a welcoming, fun environment to learn in.” (*Psychology of Work, Fall 2023*)
- “Katie is very supportive and encourages students to share their ideas, even if they aren’t fully confident in them.” (*Sociology of Work and Organizations, Spring 2026*)

Clarity and original materials

- “She made slides recapping class content based on her own notes from lecture and was always available to answer questions.” (*Sociology of Work, Spring 2024*)
- “She clarifies a lot of lecture content and allows ample opportunity for participation.” (*Psychology of Work, Fall 2023*)
- “Katie is one of the best TAs I have ever had. I would highly recommend her.” (*Sociology of Work, Spring 2024*)